

0.0.1 Janavasabha (excerpt)

1. Thus was heard by me. At one time the Auspicious One was dwelling in Natika at the brick hall. At that time, at each and every place within the country, the Auspicious One declared the birth of disciples who had died and passed away. Among the Kasis and the Kosalans, the Vajjis and the Mallas, the Cetas and the Vamsas, the Kurus and the Pancalas, the Macchas and the Surasenans: “That one arose there, that one arose there.” “More than fifty disciples from Natika who had died and passed away, from the complete extinction of the five fetters that binds one to the near shore, come to be born spontaneously, bound to attained final nibbana in that place, not subject to return from that world. More than ninety disciples from Natika who

janavasabhasuttam
(excerpt)

evaṃ me sutam: ekaṃ samayaṃ bhagavā nātike¹ viharati giñ-jakāvasathe. tena kho pana samayena bhagavā parito parito janapadesu paricārake abbatthite kālakate upapattīsu byākaroti, kāsikosalesu vajjimallesu cetivaṃsesu² kurupañcālesu macchasūrasenesu asu amutra upapanno asu amutra upapanno ti. paropaññāsaṃ nātikiyā paricārakā abbatthitā kālakatā pañcannaṃ orambhāgiyānaṃ saññojanānaṃ parikkhayā opapātikā tattha parinibbāyino anāvattidhammā tasmā lokā. sādhiḥkā navutti nātikiyā paricārakā ab-

had died and passed away, from the complete extinction of the three fetters and the reduction of greed, hatred and delusion, are once-returners, who having come back only once to this world, make the end of suffering. More than five hundred disciples from Natika who had died and passed away, from the complete extinction of the three fetters, are stream-enterers, not subject to the woeful plane, on a fixed course, destined for supreme awakening.”

2. The [Natika people] heard of the Natika disciples: Apparently at each and every place within the country, the Auspicious One declared the birth of disciples who had died and passed away. Among the Kasis and the Kosalans, the Vajjis and the Mallas, the Cetas and the Vamsas, the Kurus and

bhatitā kālakatā tiṇṇaṃ saññojanānaṃ parikkhayā rāgado-samohānaṃ tanuttā sakadāgāmino saki-deva³ imaṃ lokaṃ āgantvā dukkhassantaṃ karissanti. sātirekāni pañcasatāni nātikiyā paricārakā abbhātītā kālakatā, tiṇṇaṃ saññojanānaṃ parikkhayā sotāpannā avinipātadhammā niyatā sambodhiparāyaṇā ti.

assosum kho nātikiyā paricārakā: bhagavā kira parito parito janapadesu paricārake abbhātite kālakate upapattīsu byākaroti kāsikosalesu vajjimallesu cetivamsesu kurupañcālesu macchasūrasenesu asu amutra upapanno asu amutra

the Pancalas, the Macchas and the Surasenas: “That one arose there, that one arose there.” “More than fifty disciples from Natika who had died and passed away, from the complete extinction of the five fetters that binds one to the near shore, come to be born spontaneously, bound to attained final nibbana in that place, not subject to return from that world. More than ninety disciples from Natika who had died and passed away, from the complete extinction of the three fetters and the reduction of greed, hatred and delusion, are once-returners, who having come back only once to this world, make the end of suffering. More than five hundred disciples from Natika who had died and passed away, from the complete extinction of the three fetters, are stream-enterers, not subject to the woeful plane, on a fixed course, destined for

upapanno’ti. paro-
paññāsaṃ nātikiyā
paricārakā abbha-
tītā kālakatā pañ-
cannaṃ orambhā-
giyānaṃ saññoja-
nānaṃ parikkhayā
opapātikā tattha pa-
rinibbāyino anāvatti-
dhammā tasmā lokā.
sādhikā navuti nāti-
kiyā paricārakā ab-
bhatītā kālakatā tiṇ-
ṇaṃ saññojanānaṃ
parikkhayā rāgado-
samohānaṃ tanuttā
sakadāgāmino saki-
deva imaṃ lokaṃ
āgantvā dukkhassan-
taṃ karissanti. sāti-
rekāni pañcasatāni
nātikiyā paricārakā
abbhatītā kālakatā
tiṇṇaṃ saññojanā-
naṃ parikkhayā so-
tāpannā avinipāta-
dhammā niyatā sam-
bodhiparāyaṇā”ti.
tena ca nātikiyā pa-
ricārakā attamanā

supreme awakening.” And by that the Natika disciples, having heard the Auspicious One’s answer to the question, became pleased, greatly delighted, full of joy and happiness.

3. The venerable Ananda heard: Apparently at each and every place within the country, the Auspicious One declared the birth of disciples who had died and passed away. Among the Kasis and the Kosalans, the Vajjis and the Mallas, the Cetas and the Vamsas, the Kurus and the Pancalas, the Macchas and the Surasenas: “That one arose there, that one arose there.” “More than fifty disciples from Natika who had died and passed away, from the complete extinction of the five fetters that binds one to the near shore, come to be born spontaneously, bound to attained final nibbana in

ahesum pamuditā
pītisomanassajātā
bhagavato pañhavey-
yākaraṇaṃ⁴ sutvā.

assosi kho āyasmā
ānando: bhagavā
kira parito parito ja-
napadesu paricārake
abbhatīte kālakate
upapattīsu byākaroti.
kāśikosalesu vajji-
mallesu cetivaṃsesu
kurupañcālesu mac-
chasūrasenesu asu
amutra upapanno
asu amutra upapanno
ti. paropaññāsanā-
tikiyā paricārakā
abbhatītā kālakatā
pañcannaṃ oram-
bhāgiyānaṃ sañño-
janānaṃ parikkhayā
opapātikā tattha pa-
rinibbāyino anāvatti-
dhammā tasmā lokā.
sādhikā navuti nāti-

that place, not subject to return from that world. More than ninety disciples from Natika who had died and passed away, from the complete extinction of the three fetters and the reduction of greed, hatred and delusion, are once-returners, who having come back only once to this world, make the end of suffering. More than five hundred disciples from Natika who had died and passed away, from the complete extinction of the three fetters, are stream-enterers, not subject to the woeful plane, on a fixed course, destined for supreme awakening.” And by that the Natika disciples, having heard the Auspicious One answer to the question, became pleased, greatly delighted, full of joy and happiness.

4. Then this occurred to the venerable Ananda: “But there

kiyā paricārakā ab-
bhatītā kālakatā tiṇ-
ṇaṃ saññojanānaṃ
parikkhayā rāgado-
samohānaṃ tanuttā
sakadāgāmino saki-
deva imaṃ lokam
āgantvā dukkhas-
antaṃ karissanti,
sātirekāni pañcasa-
tāni nātikiyā paricā-
rakā abbhatītā kāla-
katā tiṇṇaṃ sañño-
janānaṃ parikkhayā
sotāpannā avinipā-
tadhammā niyatā
sambodhiparāyaṇā
ti. tena ca nātikiyā
paricārakā attamaṇā
aheṣuṃ pamuditā
pītisomanassajātā
bhagavato pañhavey-
yākaraṇaṃ sutvā”ti.

atha kho āyasmato
ānandassa etada-
hosi: ime kho pa-

were also these Magadhan disciples who have died and passed away, many of whom are really of long standing. One would think that Anga and Magadha are empty of Angans and Magadhans who have died and passed away. Yet, those too had confidence in the Buddha, confidence in the Dhamma, confidence in the Sangha, fulfilled in the virtues, [and now] have died and passed away. The Auspicious One has not declared [their birth]. It would be good to have a declaration of them. Many people would gain confidence, and from that, they would go to a happy destination.

5. Also this king of Magadha, Seniya Bimbisara, was righteous, a lawful king who was a benefactor of Brahmins and Householders, town and country folks. So much so that the citizens dwell singing

nāpi¹ ahesum mā-gadhakā paricārakā bahū ceva rattaññū ca abbhatītā kālakatā. suññā maññe aṅgamagadhā aṅga-māgadhakehi² paricārakehi abbhatītehi kālakatehi. te kho panāpi ahesum buddhe pasannā dhamme pasannā saṅghe pasannā sīlesu paripūrakārino te abbhatītā kālakatā bhagavatā abyākatā. te sampassa³ sādhu veyyākaraṇaṃ. bahujano pasīdeyya tato gaccheyya sugatiṃ.

ayaṃ kho panāpi ahosi rājā māgadho seniyo bimbisāro dhammiko dhammarājā hito brāhmaṇa-gahapatikānaṃ negamānañceva jānapadānañca. apissu-

his praises: “That righteous lawful king, having brought us so much happiness, has passed away. Life was so easy for us in that righteous, lawful king’s kindom.” Yet, he too had confidence in the Buddha, confidence in the Dhamma, confidence in the Sangha, fulfilled in the virtues, [and now] have died and passed away. The Auspicious One has not declared [their birth]. It would be good to have a declaration of them. Many people would gain confidence, and from that, they would go to a happy destination. Besides, the Auspicious One became supremely awakened in Magadha. [Since] the place where the Auspicious One became supremely awakened was in Magadha, why wouldn’t the Auspicious One declare the birth of the Magadhans disciples who have died and passed away in that place? Yet, were the

dam manussā kittayamānarūpā viharanti ‘evaṃ no so dhammiko dhammarājā sukhāpetvā kālakato, evaṃ mayam tassa dhammikkassa dhammarañño vijite phāsu⁴ viharimhā’ti. so kho panāpi ahosi buddhe pasanno dhamme pasanno saṅghe pasanno sīlesu paripūrakārī. apissudam manussā evamāhaṃsu ‘yāva maraṇakālāpi rājā māgadho seniyo bimbisāro bhagavantaṃ kittayamānarūpo kālakato’ti. so abbhatīto kālakato bhagavatā abyākato. tassa passa sādhu veyyākaraṇaṃ. bahujano pasīdeyya, tato gaccheyya sugatīṃ. bhagavato kho pana sambodhi ma-

Auspicious One not to declare the birth of the Magadhans disciples who have died and passed away, that would be a cause of distress among the Magadhan disciples. But since that would be a cause of distress for the Magadhan disciples, why wouldn't the Auspicious One make a declaration about them?"

gadhesu. yattha kho bhagavato sambodhi magadhesu, kathaṃ tattha bhagavā mā-gadhake paricārake abbhatīte kālakate upapattīsu na byā-kareyya? bhagavā ceva kho pana mā-gadhake paricārake abbhatīte kālakate upapattīsu na byā-kareyya dīnamanā tenassu māgadhakā paricārakā. yena kho panassu dīnamanā māgadhakā paricārakā kathaṃ te bhagavā na byāka-reyyāti.

